No grain have I by which I can be fed,
No rhyme of grain wherewith I can be clad;
The man who lacks both food and clothes,
In art or science, where can he compete?

In those days of the pause, Babur was generally in a poetic mood. He went on to answer the quatrain of Mulla Binai through a Turki quatrain which when translated into English reads as below:[†]

As is the wish of your heart, so shall it be;
For gift and stipend both an order shall be made;
I know the grain and its rhyme you write of;
The garments, you, your house, the corn shall fill.

The sequence of poetic exchange took place for a while. Mulla responded with a quatrain which read as below:[‡]

Mīrzā-of-mine, the Lord of sea and land shall be;
His art and skill, the world over, the evening tale shall be;
If gifts like these reward one rhyming word;
For words of sense, what guerdon will there be?

The winter continued well for Babur and Shaybāni's fate had begun to wane exponentially except for two things:

1. The Merv men who had taken Qara-kul, could not be persuaded to stay there and it went back into the control of the Aūzbegs.
2. Shaybāni Khān besieged Ibrahim Tarkhān's younger brother, Ahmad in Dabı He had stormed into the place and massacred the inhabitants before Babur's army could even begin to march becoming a saviour.

Babur was able to take back Samarkand with the help of only twenty dozen of his able men. Babur has mentioned that for five to six months, Allah seemed to favouring his fate completely. And to him, this certainly was no less than a miracle when his men fought the arrayed battle of Sar-i-Pul (below) with a man like Shaybāni Khān. Babur was getting good rounds of help. A few of them have been recorded in the *Baburnama*:

1. Around 5000 Barins along with Ayub Begchik and Qashka Mahmud had cor from the Khān.